15_AUTH.md

Authentication Specification

Version 1.0

Status: MVP

Purpose

Authentication is the user's first interaction with UNPLND.

It must feel effortless.

Fast.

Trustworthy.

Premium.

Authentication should disappear.

The goal is to get users into the app as quickly as possible.

Authentication Philosophy

Never create friction.

Never ask unnecessary questions.

Never require information that is not immediately needed.

The user wants to experience the app.

Not fill out forms.

Supported Login Methods

Priority Order

1.

Apple Sign In (iOS)

2.

Google Sign In

3.

Email & Password

Future

Passkeys

Phone Number

Magic Link

Authentication Flow

Launch App

↓

Splash Screen

↓

Check Session

↓

Authenticated?

↓

YES

↓

Go Home

↓

NO

↓

Welcome

↓

Sign In

↓

Home

Target Time

<2 seconds

Splash Screen

Purpose

Restore session.

Load user.

Check onboarding.

Check authentication.

Never display longer than necessary.

Maximum duration

2 seconds

Welcome Screen

Contains

Logo

Headline

Short value proposition

Apple Button

Google Button

Email Button

Privacy Notice

Terms Link

Only one scroll view.

Never overwhelm.

Email Registration

Required

First Name

Email

Password

Optional

Profile Picture

Everything else comes later.

Password Rules

Minimum

8 characters

Must contain

Uppercase

Lowercase

Number

Special Character

Live validation.

Never validate only after submission.

Sign In

Options

Apple

Google

Email

Remember Session

Automatic Login

Biometric Unlock (Future)

Forgot Password

Simple flow.

Email

↓

Send Reset

↓

Confirmation

Never expose whether an email exists.

Email Verification

Required before sensitive actions.

Not required before exploring the app.

Never block onboarding unnecessarily.

Guest Mode

Optional

User may explore.

Cannot

Create Albums

Sync Data

Premium

Cloud Backup

Prompt to create account only when needed.

Never force registration immediately.

Session Management

Automatically restore session.

Refresh tokens silently.

Never ask users to login repeatedly.

Logout removes:

Cached profile

Sensitive tokens

Secure credentials

Preserve

Theme

Language

Accessibility settings

Account Linking

Support

Apple

Google

Email

Users can connect multiple providers.

Never create duplicate accounts.

Delete Account

Available inside Settings.

Flow

Tap Delete

↓

Warning

↓

Password Confirmation

↓

Delete

↓

Sign Out

↓

Welcome

Deletion must remove all personal data.

GDPR compliant.

Error Handling

Examples

Wrong Password

↓

Friendly message

No Internet

↓

Offline explanation

Server Error

↓

Retry

Expired Session

↓

Automatic refresh

↓

Login only if refresh fails

Never expose Firebase errors.

Loading States

Buttons become loading.

Inputs disabled.

Small progress indicator.

No blocking overlay.

Security

Secure Storage only.

No plaintext tokens.

Firestore Security Rules.

Rate limiting.

HTTPS only.

Validate everything server-side.

UI Components

Primary Button

Secondary Button

Apple Button

Google Button

Email Form

Password Field

Loading Indicator

Error Banner

Animations

Welcome

Fade

Logo

Small scale

Buttons

Slide Up

Successful Login

Soft fade

Home appears naturally.

Haptics

Selection

↓

Button Tap

Success

↓

Authentication Complete

Error

↓

Invalid Credentials

Accessibility

VoiceOver

Large Text

High Contrast

Reduced Motion

Keyboard Navigation (Future)

Analytics Events

auth_screen_view

login_started

login_success

login_failed

register_started

register_success

logout

account_deleted

Only meaningful events.

Edge Cases

No Internet

↓

Retry

Google Cancelled

↓

Return

Apple Cancelled

↓

Return

Email Exists

↓

Suggest Login

Token Expired

↓

Refresh

Refresh Failed

↓

Login

Never trap users.

Acceptance Criteria

User downloads app.

↓

Opens app.

↓

Signs in.

↓

Reaches Home.

↓

Total time

Under one minute.

No confusion.

No unnecessary friction.

DO NOT

Do NOT ask for birthday.

Do NOT ask for gender.

Do NOT ask for interests.

Do NOT ask for mood during authentication.

Do NOT request location before explaining why.

Do NOT force profile customization.

Do NOT interrupt login with popups.

Do NOT show technical errors.

Future Improvements

Passkeys

Face ID Unlock

Touch ID Unlock

Magic Links

Multiple Profiles

Family Accounts

Business Accounts

Claude Instructions

Authentication should feel invisible.

If users think about authentication,

it is already too complicated.

Minimize friction.

Maximize trust.

Protect security.

Never sacrifice UX.

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